

Mikel Rosenthal

SENIOR UI DESIGNER · VISUAL CRAFT · DESIGN SYSTEMS · IOS · ANDROID · WEB

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I. SUMMARY

Visual-craft-obsessed UI designer with 24 years making complex software beautiful — typography, spacing, color, motion, and the interaction details most teams never get to. Deep history in regulated healthcare and enterprise products: core contributor to GE Healthcare's Edison Design System (2020 Red Dot for Interface Design), builder of Blue Cross Blue Shield's FIBER system, cross-platform component work at Verizon spanning iOS, Android, and web with platform-native fidelity to Apple's HIG and Material Design. Knows design systems from every seat — built five from scratch (Avant, BCBS, TransUnion, SurePeople, The Bettering Company), contributed modules to mature systems at GE and Verizon, and works comfortably as both user and builder. Prototypes beyond Figma: high-fidelity interactions in HTML/CSS, AI-assisted production code with Claude Code. Accessibility (WCAG) built in by default. Founder of PBK Studio. *Unmistakable visual worlds, built to scale.*

II. EXPERIENCE

PBK Studio *Founder & Owner* MAY 2026 – PRESENT

DESIGN SYSTEMS · PRODUCT · BRAND · WEB · MOTION · VOICE · AI-NATIVE WORKFLOWS

Independent multidisciplinary studio designing composable design systems, AI-augmented product experiences, generative brand identity, and original music/voice work for enterprise and consumer clients.

- Engagements span enterprise design systems (healthcare, fintech, insurance), real estate microsites, brand identity, and responsive web.
- Deliverables ship with governance, accessibility, and developer handoff built in — Figma-first, with clear documentation and contribution patterns.
- Original music released as PitchBlackKnight; SAG-eligible voice performance for commercial, narrative, and sonic branding.

Verizon *Senior Design System Designer II* DEC 2025 – JAN 2026

SHORT-TERM CONTRACT VIA INSIGHT GLOBAL · FULLY REMOTE

Focused engagement on Verizon's post-rebrand enterprise design system — owned the system's tokens, variables, and component architecture in Figma, driving component parity across native iOS, Android, and web with platform-native fidelity to Apple's HIG and Material Design, and design-to-code alignment through Dev Mode and Code Connect.

The Bettering Company *Brand Designer* MAY 2024 – AUG 2025

FREELANCE · REMOTE / CHICAGO, IL

Built a new brand identity and lightweight design system, translating the company's core values into a cohesive visual language and shipping-ready guidelines.

- Generated and refined a wide range of logo concepts — exploring form, symbolism, and narrative to capture the brand's mission.
- Established brand guidelines and flexible foundations for consistent application across digital and physical touchpoints.

Avant *Senior Product, UI/UX & Design Systems* MAY 2021 – AUG 2024

FULL-TIME · HYBRID / CHICAGO, IL

Led design and development of Avant's Pathfinder Design System and a marketing design library spanning product and brand.

- Defined visual language, component architecture, governance model, and contribution patterns for multi-platform consistency.
- Designed dense, data-heavy advisor tooling in a dark-themed product UI; partnered with engineering on reusable Figma libraries and themeable variants.
- Introduced a brand/marketing design library that streamlined consistency for 350+ marketers.

GE Healthcare *Senior UX/UI Product Designer, Design Systems* JAN 2020 – FEB 2021

CONTRACT · HYBRID / CHICAGO, IL

Core contributor to the award-winning Edison Design System — designed and evangelized modules as part of the team behind a foundation unifying 40+ regulated clinical and enterprise healthcare products.

- Developed scalable Figma component libraries and UX documentation adopted across diverse clinical product teams and device surfaces.
- Central role in winning the 2020 Red Dot Award, Fast Company Innovation by Design, and dmi:DVA Award for Interface Design.
- Partnered with accessibility and compliance teams to ensure usability across regulated healthcare environments.

SurePeople *Lead UX/UI Visual Product Designer* JUN 2020 – SEP 2020

CONTRACT · REMOTE / CHICAGO, IL

Led UX and visual design of the PRISM psychometric platform, translating complex behavioral data into clear, human-readable visualization.

- Defined interaction models, visual hierarchy, and IA for complex data visualization; built the platform's modular UI system from scratch in Figma.

Blue Cross Blue Shield *Senior Product / Design Systems Designer* MAY 2018 – DEC 2019

CONTRACT · HYBRID / CHICAGO, IL

Created and maintained the FIBER Design System — a React-compatible framework that accelerated product-to-market timelines.

- Defined typography, color, grids, iconography, and coded components with theming hooks for unified brand consistency.
- Partnered with developers to translate designs into React components; mentored teams in accessibility and documentation standards.

TransUnion *Senior UX Designer, Design Systems* MAY 2018 – JUN 2019

CONTRACT · HYBRID / CHICAGO, IL

Designed the global TUCM Design System and visual identity for customer-facing and internal applications.

- Built responsive, scalable UI libraries; established universal style guidelines and design-to-code workflows.

Maven Wave / Eviden *UX Team Senior Lead, Design Systems* JAN 2005 – MAY 2018

FULL-TIME · HYBRID / CHICAGO, IL

Directed conceptual and visual direction across Fortune 500 client projects, integrating UX principles with brand storytelling.

- Established scalable design workflows and early design-system patterns for clients including Google, AT&T, and Nike.
- Created prototypes, journey maps, and digital ecosystems across app, web, and co-branded products; mentored design teams.

Biersma Creative *Senior Designer & UX Lead* JAN 2006 – JAN 2013

FULL-TIME · CHICAGO, IL

Led visual brand and UX direction across healthcare, retail, and entertainment for clients including Aflac, AbbVie, Crate & Barrel, Disney, Google, Nike, Herman Miller, and Salesforce.

Firebelly Design *Junior Graphic Designer* JAN 2002 – JAN 2005

FULL-TIME · CHICAGO, IL

Concept-to-execution brand and web design; print and digital for ComEd, Petco, Harris Bank, and Scholastic.

III. SKILLS

UI & Visual Design Craft · Typography · Layout & Composition · Color · Native Mobile UI (Apple HIG · Material Design) · Cross-Platform (iOS · Android · Web) · Design Systems — Module-Based (5 built from scratch · contributor at GE & Verizon) · Interaction & Motion Design · Micro-Interactions · High-Fidelity Prototyping (Figma, HTML/CSS, AI-assisted with Claude Code) · Complex Data Visualization · Regulated Healthcare & Enterprise UI · Accessibility-by-Default (WCAG 2.2 / 3.0) · Figma (Variables, Dev Mode, Code Connect) · Adobe Creative Suite · Design-to-Code Collaboration

IV. AWARDS & EDUCATION

2020 Red Dot Award — Interface Design

EDISON DESIGN SYSTEM · GE HEALTHCARE

2020 Fast Company — Innovation by Design

2020 dmi:DVA — Design Value Award

MSU Film Festival — 1st, Published Works

Missouri State University · Springfield, MO

BFA, SUMMA CUM LAUDE — ELECTRONIC ARTS & DESIGN

MINOR: MASS MEDIA & COMMUNICATIONS